

Statements

(internal, RU only; base for external reviewers; and post-tenure review)

Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn

Wednesday 13th May, 2026 17:40

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1 Background Information

My home department, public policy and administration (PPA), is a relatively hostile work environment. Most likely there will be some unfounded negativity, so I would like to respond to it. In particular it would be useful for you to be critical of PPA's faculty opinions. For instance, they have argued that I underperform in certain areas, while the metrics point to the contrary. See Appendix: Background Information.

2 Research

I am in the field of social indicators, quality of life, wellbeing, and life satisfaction. The main journals are *Applied Research in Quality of Life* (ARIQ) and *Social Indicators Research* (SIR).¹ The main academic/professional organization is International Society for Quality-of-Life Studies (ISQOLS). My field is thinner on theory than other social science, (post-)positivist, and quantitative—about patterns, relationships, and effects—but rather correlational than causal. (Quasi-)experiments are very rare, and there are more descriptions and visualizations than economics and statistics. My field is somewhere between geography, sociology, psychology, and philosophy.² My interests have been broad, including politics (Okulicz-Kozaryn et al. 2014), volunteering (Morawski et al. 2022), and agency (D'Italia and Okulicz-Kozaryn 2025).

All research is (supposed to be) new in some sense, but my research is more original/innovative than most. Many contribute only incrementally, say by slightly improving a model, adding an interaction or instrumental variables. My contribution is new ideas—human creativity is even more important in current AI age. I have creative ideas, and then able to find the right data to test them. I was the first to look at several relationships:³ effect of energy use on happiness (Okulicz-Kozaryn and Altman 2019), effect of social v individual religiosity on happiness across countries (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2010), and on trust in the US (Valente and Okulicz-Kozaryn 2021); effect of religiosity on creativity across space (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2015).

My main area of research has been urban-rural happiness gradient, a term coined in my early paper on the topic: “An urban-rural happiness gradient” (Berry and Okulicz-Kozaryn 2011). This line of research is not entirely new—it has been studied in a quantitative fashion in a limited way in the 70s and philosophically since antiquity—but mine are the first studies in modern times.⁴ And I have a related line of research looking at livability of places: Okulicz-Kozaryn (2013), Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente (2019).

My urban-rural happiness gradient research includes careful gradient elaboration (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2016) and theory-rich Okulicz-Kozaryn and Mazelis (2018). As the research has matured, I added: generational differences (Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente 2018), growing-up (Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente 2020), panel data (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2023), elaborated happiness measurement (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2024), and Covid19's effect (Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente 2026). Finally, Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente (2021) shows that urban unhappiness is common across countries.

I work with students to explore the gradient further: examined population change instead of level (Okulicz-Kozaryn et al. 2024), and turned to non-WEIRD (Western, Educated, Industrialized, Rich, and Democratic) societies: India (Deb and Okulicz-Kozaryn 2023), Egypt (Mikhaeil et al. 2024), and Colombia (Okulicz-Kozaryn et al. 2026).

Near-future trajectory remains similar: mostly urban-rural happiness gradient and regional happiness, adding Latin American focus (Okulicz-Kozaryn and Martinez 2025). I plan to spend more time on grant writing to grow my research group, hire students and post-docs, and do course buy-outs.⁵

Since 2017, when I have submitted my materials for promotion to associate professor with tenure, I have published 37 peer-reviewed articles, including 7 in *Cities*, a journal with impact factor (IF)=8.1, higher than the top journal in public administration in the US,⁶ *Public Administration Review* with IF=7.2.⁷ Since 2017 I have also published 4 articles in *Social Indicators Research*, and 9 in *Applied Research in Quality of Life*, both leading/main journals in my field. I am also collegial and collaborative—I've coauthored with over 20 authors (Scopus), and my citations more than tripled (Scopus) or doubled (Google Scholar) since 2017.⁸

¹Journal of Happiness Studies has shifted towards positive psychology and happiness economics. ARIQ is the flagship journal of ISQOLS.

²Geography is a notable part of it—my research intersects with geography: regions, and especially urban-rural gradient. This is a subjective description of the field, or rather sub-field, and this is where I fit. There are other sub-fields, notably positive psychology and happiness economics—they are related but different in important ways. My field is well described by its pioneer, Alex Michalos: Michalos (2014b,a).

³In quantitative way, focusing on and elaborating the relationship (not just listing among others or controlling for it). You will see in my many papers that the idea is indeed the first of its kind—nobody has looked at the relationship before in this way.

⁴There is a 30-40 year generational gap between mostly 70s and very few in early 80s versus my first study in 2009.

⁵I already spend more time on http://pivot.proquest.com/funding_opps/ and collaborate with Todd Regn (RU-Camden grant expert) on grant ideas.

⁶I am in a department of public policy and administration in the US.

⁷<https://www.scimagojr.com/journalsearch.php?q=16956&tip=sid> and <https://www.scimagojr.com/journalsearch.php?q=17167&tip=sid>

⁸And my citations on Google Scholar after having stalled for 5 years (haven't stalled on Scopus) are set to increase from 350 in 2025 to over 400 in 2026: On April 28, I'm cited at 143, it's 118th day of the year, so I have $143/118 = 1.2$ citations per day; $1.2 * 365 > 400$. Scopus: <https://>

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3 Teaching

Something I have dreaded as a student, and promised myself I won't do on the other side as an instructor. Style over substance: prioritizing appearance, aesthetics, and presentation over actual quality, meaning, and functionality—it looks and sounds impressive but lacks value, real utility—just like with much of social science prose.⁹ Most instruction was unnecessarily fluffy and ornamented, often grandiose as if the goal is to put student in a sense of awe.

Now as an instructor I skip the fluff and cut to the chase—convey practical information efficiently. Usefulness/utility is the key. Learning by doing, no memorizing—for instance, students bring their own data and we apply skills and tools learned in the class to the data, no exams. When I was a student I was forced to memorize theory and formulas and read hundreds of pages of formal texts. But I wasn't taught how to use the skills and the tools. I condense the material, make it relevant, maximize utility/usefulness with minimum effort, focus on what's most important in most accessible practical hands on way.

Students appreciate my teaching style, e.g., “left a lasting impression on me and I appreciated your approach and teaching style” and “Your passion for education has inspired and impacted me in so many ways. Your commitment to helping your students grow and learn is truly admirable. Thank you for all that you do!”

I decrease instruction and increase interaction: discussions, presentations, “flip the class,”¹⁰ and extra labs in addition to the class. Such interactive social approach seems even more important in current reality: short attention span, information overload, AI, and mental health problems. We need to connect, be at ease, have good energy, and even some fun in class—it shouldn't be tedious and gruesome, at least not all of it.

It is not watering down the curriculum. I provide plenty of extra/bonus materials so that it is customized to a student, doesn't overwhelm with unnecessary stuff, but provides enough depth and individual learning path. Pleasant learning experience matters, but so do outcomes.

I want my teaching to produce results. Learning (motivation, too) is the direct result. But then comes transfer of knowledge, ability to apply that learned information. We need results either in academia or outside of it.

Since 2020, I graduated 4 PhDs, they all have a job. One is at SIPRI (Stockholm International Peace Research Institute), a think-tank ranked 11th or 31st worldwide.¹¹ Another one at Virginia Tech and the other 2 were employed at Rutgers when graduated. My students publish. Since 2020, we have published 10 peer-reviewed papers with my students in good journals including 3 in top ranked *Cities with Impact Factor* of 8.1.

One highlight is that the skills learned in the classes not only work in the academic research, but also in the real world: “The classes I took with you are helping not only my scholarship, but my day job [...] I greatly appreciate it.” and “subject: Received a Job Offer [...] I would like to thank you for all of the guidance and knowledge during all of your data-related courses the past several semesters to help me get to the point I am at today.” and “since graduating I have continued to pursue more projects in the coding world. Some analysis projects, business models, [...] I appreciate all the help and motivation you gave me in class as it helped me to really see what I can come up with from all of the useful tools, how to plan and build on projects, and skills gained from having you as my professor.”

I try to guide students individually, in the grand scheme of things, teaching is about helping students become who they are, and everyone is little different. This is another reason for forcing less required material and making more available as bonus/extra for self-actualization. I make sure I am available and approachable for students spending extra time outside of classroom: working on papers, being accessible via zoom and in person, including when on sabbatical. Now in Spring 2026 I am on sabbatical, but I still have 4 students enrolled in my dissertation hours, and I work with other students on papers informally.

Two final points on my teaching philosophy. I support public/civic service/engagement in my teaching. All my classes encourage

⁹See <https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s11192-012-0937-9>.

¹⁰Work on projects and homework collaboratively in class as opposed to home as done traditionally.

¹¹<https://thinktankalert.com/rankings> and <https://guides.library.upenn.edu/c.php?g=1035991&p=7509972>

(but not force) and give extra credit for it. And I support students even after the class in their civic endeavors—see service section. But this is not activism, it is evidence based, data driven analysis and problem-solving. It is rather positivistic “what is”, than normative “what should be,”¹² I support in my teaching old fashioned critical thinking, I don’t believe classroom is a place for political indoctrination of the students. I’m (post-)positivist in my teaching—I encourage students to try to get closer to the objective truth through evidence and data. Activism and political action are better left to politicians.

I concluded my teaching philosophy, now turning to technicalities. One highlight is unusually heavy curriculum development. Since coming to Rutgers-Camden in 2012, I have taught over 10 different classes, developed from scratch most of them, including 3 courses in 2023 for our new data science program. I am updating my teaching materials each time I teach a class. Also, I mostly teach methods classes, which often receive lower evaluations.

I teach, mentor, and support students from different programs. In my home department of public policy and administration (PPA), I teach regularly in Masters of Public Administration (MPA) and MS and PhD in Public Affairs, but I also teach regularly students from MS in Data science in my always cross listed PPA courses. Usually there are also few PhDs from Prevention Science, and occasionally from other departments such as Psychology, and Criminology and Sociology.

I strive to improve my teaching: I just attended cybersecurity trainings¹³, and attended Instructional Design and Technology (IDT) workshop on “Crafting the Learner-Centered Syllabus” in 2024. And I quite regularly read on teaching and mentoring advice, tips and tricks on [nature.com](https://www.nature.com), [chronicle.com](https://www.chronicle.com), and [insidehighered.com](https://www.insidehighered.com).

My feature teaching preference would be to continue with the classes I have already taught, and there are plenty of them, over 10. My strength and preference is data science classes, but also happiness class that aligns with my research. I have been also developing a new class “social indicators” that would be broader than just happiness and include topics such as trust, freedom, and meaning. This would also align with my editorial position at Social Indicators Research journal.

I am interested in teaching short courses / microcredentials. I have already taught a short GIS course¹⁴ twice, informally, for my colleagues from the department and other faculty from Arts and Sciences, and for Walter Rand Institute. But I would like to teach more often and other short courses. There is an initiative to create Microcredentials and Digital Badges—I would like to participate in it.

I am 2025 recipient of department’s Jay A Sigler award for “outstanding service and dedication to students” (awarded by students); the plaque says “this award is given to the faculty member who exhibits a commitment to student’s academic development and personal growth.”

¹²Similar to Network of Schools of Public Policy, Affairs, and Administration (NASPAA) competency: “to analyze, synthesize, think critically, solve problems and make decisions.”

¹³2026 KnowBe4 Security Awareness Training, Cybersecurity Essentials: Secure Passwords, and Introduction to IT Security Policies—these enhance my classroom teaching—most of my courses involve computer coding or data science—cybersecurity matters more there than in usual social science courses.

¹⁴<https://theaok.github.io/shortGIS/>

4 Service

My service mostly builds on and derives from my main focus and strength, research. I provide such service in two main ways: 1) to the profession/scholarly field, and 2) to students.

I review about 3-4/mo or 36-48/year papers for journals, including the top journals such as Journal of Personality and Social Psychology and Public Administration Review (see CV for details). Reviewing is an essential foundation of scholarly fields, and increasingly in short supply—something I can attest to as a journal editor. Since January 2024, I co-edit Social Indicators Research, the leading journal in my field of quality of life and wellbeing. My editorial philosophy is to be mentor and helper, not just gate-keeper—for instance, I am often in favor of revision prior to external review (instead of desk-reject), and I try to guide the authors, especially the junior ones.¹⁵

My research-oriented service over past 6 years 2020-2026 to students is: published 10 peer-reviewed articles with students as co-authors, supervised 9 dissertations (4 graduated; 5 in-progress), served on 6 dissertation committees, supervised 6 data science master theses, served on 2 master thesis committees in other social science, and supervised 15 independent studies. I have also led brown bag seminars and organized a workshop on academic publishing.

And I am very excited about bringing to campus an award winning¹⁶ junior professor from Germany as a visiting scholar for 2 months in Fall 2026: Leonie C. Steckermeier. Leonie is a productive scholar already benefiting 2 of our doctoral students—we have monthly or so zoom meetings where we are already working on papers.

I contribute service to the campus and department. Over 2018-2022 I have lead the development of a new MS in data science and associated certificate program. This was a substantial undertaking and also somewhat challenging as the newly created programs are located outside of my home department. I have been serving since 2022 as a director for data science certificate.¹⁷ I am currently supervising 2 courtesy appointments as volunteer researchers in the department—they work with me on research but also helped students in my class. I frequently serve as either ad hoc chair or member on Advancement and Promotions (A&P) committee. I find this service fulfilling. I contribute to promoting quality faculty in our social sciences and I learn about my colleagues. Other committee service is enumerated in the CV.

While research-oriented service is my strength and passion, and usual campus and departmental service is my duty, I am also mindful of Rutgers-Camden public/community service/engagement mission. I agree that as a public university, we also need to engage with and provide service to the public and community. I have assisted a number of Rutgers-Camden students in their community projects over past 5 years serving as a faculty advisor for, for instance: Olorunfunmi Adebajo's internship at the Camden County Community Development Office's Homelessness Assistance Unit,¹⁸ Marlo Rossi's project at Walter Rand Institute and other projects on abortion,¹⁹ and Ojobo Agbo Eje: "Camden Health Equity Data Visualization Initiative."²⁰

New Jersey first, but I have been civically engaged outside of the Garden State as well. For instance, I have used my data management skills to assist with data collection and management for Ohio Business Round Table, and Michigan Economic Competitiveness Study.

In the ideal world, I would like to continue with research-oriented service. In particular, I would like to increase my research group and co-author more with students, and ideally postdocs. Chairing dissertations and leading independent studies would be also my strength and preference. I'm happy to take on more administrative duties such as editing another journal.

¹⁵I am grateful to the editor of Journal of Applied Psychology who has guided me when I was a junior author.

¹⁶Publications: <https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=xjkPIhwAAAAJ&hl=de>. Awards: ISQOLS Prize for the Best Dissertation on Quality of Life, Well being, and Happiness, 2nd prize, 2023; Best PhD Dissertation of the Faculty of Human Sciences, Dissertation Award of the Otto von Guericke University Magdeburg for outstanding research achievements in the context of the dissertation, 2022; Second prize of the Fritz Thyssen Foundation for the best social science paper in German for the article "Eine Krise der sozialen Anerkennung? Ergebnisse einer Bevölkerungsbefragung zu Alltagserfahrungen der Wert- und Geringschätzung in Deutschland.", 2019

¹⁷See certificates at the bottom of the page: <https://graduateschool.camden.rutgers.edu/graduate-programs>

¹⁸News item: <https://patimes.org/from-research-to-county-strategy-how-negative-learning-shaped-camden-countys-shared-housing-innovation>

¹⁹News item: <https://theconversation.com/abortion-laws-show-that-public-policy-doesnt-always-line-up-with-public-opinion-274699>

²⁰News item: <https://camden.rutgers.edu/news/rutgers-camdens-urban-innovation-fund-fuels-transformative-community-projects>

5 Appendix

5.1 Background Information

5.1.1 Post-tenure Patrice evaluation



RUTGERS-CAMDEN

College of Arts and Sciences

Faculty Post-Tenure Review 20²⁵ - 20²⁶ Academic Year

Name: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn

Department: Department of Public Policy & Administration

Rank: Associate Professor

Date of most recent review 2018



× **Tenure** **Promotion within tenured ranks** **Other post-tenure**

The post-tenure review process will take place between March 15 and May 30 of each academic year in CCAS. Please see [Rutgers Policy 60.5.6](#) for the university policy on post-tenure reviews. Broadly stated, the purpose of the post-tenure review is to:

1. **Recognize** contributions and changes.
2. **Assist** in developing a plan for long-term success of faculty.
3. **Motivate** faculty members, the College, and the University to act mutually for academic excellence.
4. **Support** in building a pathway towards desired career outcomes.

The Post-Tenure Review is a process that involves both a written summary by the faculty, department chair, and the dean as well as a guided discussion.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The faculty member must complete this Faculty Post-Tenure Review Form (DocuSign preferred), attach a current CV, and submit to the department chair by **March 15**.
2. The department chair should add their comments to the form and meet with their faculty members no later than **May 30**.
3. A final signed copy with the Chair's and Dean's comments will be retained by CCAS and shared with the faculty member.

Summary of Accomplishments for the period 20¹⁸ - 20²⁵

Teaching:

see attached

Scholarship:

see attached

Service:

see attached

Click here to add additional pages



Outline of Plans and Goals for the next five years

Teaching:

see attached

Scholarship:

see attached

Service:

see attached

Additional comments on 5-year plan (for example, upcoming promotion reviews, sabbaticals, or desire for leadership engagement):

I am going up to the full professor in the current cycle.

I am happy to discuss more leadership engagement.

Click here to add additional pages



Chair's Commentary:

Teaching:

Adam has contributed to teaching in the interdisciplinary program in Data Science, of which the primary departments are Mathematics and Computer Science. He has also served as the faculty advisor for Ojobo Agbo Eje's (Data Science) Urban Innovation Fund Grant. The project focused on designing a tool to visualize health data across the city. Dr. Okulicz-Kozaryn also received the DPPA Jay A. Sigler award for outstanding service and dedication to students in 2025.

Scholarship:

Since receiving tenure and promotion to associate professor, Adam has published over 30 peer reviewed journal articles. He has a strong focus on the field of happiness and well-being studies. He regularly publishes in *Cities*, and he has published in *Social Indicators Research*, a prominent journal focused on quality of life issues. He meets expectations in terms of quantity of publications. Adam also received an external grant (\$1500) from the South Jersey Institute for Population Health (SJIPH) in 2026.

Service:

Adam has provided commendable service to the profession by serving as an ad hoc reviewer for numerous academic journals. He has also served as a co-editor for the journal *Social Indicators Research* since 2024. At the School of Arts and Sciences Camden level, Adam's Service activities have included the Appointments and Promotions committee, the Camden Faculty Senate, and chairing the Faculty Life Committee.

Additional Comments:

Please see attached labeled additional comments

Click here to add additional pages



Dean's Commentary:

Click here to add additional pages

(Sign after Review)

We have discussed the review and five-year plan as outlined.

☐ Additional faculty comments following the review meeting are attached.

Faculty Member: _____ **Date** _____

Chair: _____ **Date** _____

Dean: _____ **Date** _____

ADAM OKULICZ-KOZARYN [updated: 2026:4]

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EMPLOYMENT

Associate Professor of Public Policy, Rutgers University, the State University of New Jersey, Camden, 2018-??

Assistant Professor of Public Policy, Rutgers University, the State University of New Jersey, Camden, 2012-18

Research Scientist at Texas Schools Project (2010-11) and Clinical Assistant Professor, UT-Dallas, 2010-12

EDUCATION

Post-doctoral Fellow, Institute for Quantitative Social Science, Harvard University, 2008-10

PhD Public Policy and Political Economy, The University of Texas at Dallas, 2008

MS Corporate and Economic Policy, Poznan University of Economics (Poland), 2003

BS Banking and Finance, Poznan School of Banking (Poland), 2001

MAJOR PUBLICATIONS (all on Google Scholar; publications with students listed under service; AOK=Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn; click text for PDF)

2026 Urbanization and Happiness. A Research Agenda for Happiness. Why we want to know, what we know, and what we want to know additionally.
Editors: Jan Ott and Ruut Veenhoven. Edward Elgar Publishing

2025 AOK, Martinez L Colombia: Unlivable but Happy. Fool's Paradise? (No, a Real Paradise, Better than the US) Applied
Research in Quality of Life

2024 D'Italia M, AOK Constructing General Human Agency Indicators (GHAIs) and a General Personal Agency Scale (GPAS)
Social Indicators Research

Urban Regrets (Unhappy Metros: Satisfaction With Life Scale (SWLS)) Heliyon

2023 Magdy Zaki E, AOK, Valente RR Subjective Well-being and Urbanization in Egypt Cities

AOK, Everett B, Magdy Zaki E, Happiness is In The Air if It Grows (Growing Places are Happier than Shrinking ones) Urban
Affairs Review

2022 Unhappy Metros: Panel Evidence Applied Research in Quality of Life

AOK, Valente R, Misanthropolis: Do Cities Promote Misanthropy? Cities

2021 AOK, Valente R, Urban unhappiness is common Cities

AOK, Morawski L, A similar effect of volunteering and pensions on subjective wellbeing of elderly Economics and Sociology

2020 Valente R, AOK, Religiosity and Trust: Evidence from the United States Review of Religious Research

AOK, Valente R, The Perennial Dissatisfaction of Urban Upbringing Cities

AOK, Morawski L, Effect of volunteering and pensions on subjective wellbeing of elderly—are there cross-country differences?
Applied Research in Quality of Life

2019 Are we happier among our own race? Economics and Sociology

AOK, Altman M, The Energy Paradox: Energy Use And Happiness Applied Research in Quality of Life

2018 AOK, Valente R, No Urban Malaise for Millennials Regional Studies

2017 AOK, Valente R, Livability and Subjective Wellbeing Across European Cities Applied Research in Quality of Life

Strzelecka M, AOK, Is tourism conducive to residents' social trust? Evidence from large-scale surveys. Tourism Review

AOK, Valente R, Life Satisfaction of Career Women and Housewives Applied Research in Quality of Life

AOK, Valente R, City Life: Glorification, Desire, and the Unconscious Size Fetish, ed. by I Kapoor, in Psychoanalysis and the Global, University of Nebraska Press

AOK, Golden L, Happiness is flextime Applied Research in Quality of Life

2016 AOK, Strzelecka M, Happy Tourists, Unhappy Locals Social Indicators Research

Happiness Research for Public Policy and Administration Transforming Government: People, Process and Policy

Unhappy Metropolis (When American City Is Too Big) Cities

AOK, Mazelis J M, More Unequal in Income, More Unequal in WellBeing Social Indicators Research

AOK, Mazelis J M, Urbanism and Happiness: A Test of Wirth's Theory of Urban Life Urban Studies

2015 Freedom and Life Satisfaction in Transition Society and Economy

AOK, Nash T, Tursi N O, Luxury Car Owners Are Not Happier Than Frugal Car Owners International Review of Economics

The More Religiosity, the Less Creativity Across US Counties Business Creativity & the Creative Economy

Income Inequality and Wellbeing Applied Research in Quality of Life

!!: this book is excluded from the promotion packet (this is a popular science book) Happiness and Place: Cities v Nature. Why Life is Better Outside of the City? Palgrave Macmillan

2014 AOK, Holmes IV O, Avery D R, The Subjective Well-Being Political Paradox: Happy Welfare States and Unhappy Liberals
Journal of Applied Psychology

Winners and Losers in Transition: Preferences For Redistribution and Nostalgia For Communism In Eastern Europe
Kyklos

'Freedom From' and 'Freedom To' across countries Social Indicators Research

Natural Sprawl Administration & Society (Disputatio Sine Fine section) (section of the journal reviewed by editor only)

2013 Cluttered Writing: Adjectives and Adverbs in Academia Scientometrics

City Life: Rankings (Livability) vs Perceptions (Satisfaction) Social Indicators Research

2012 Does Religious Diversity Make Us Unhappy? Mental Health, Religion & Culture

Income and Well-being across European Provinces Social Indicators Research

2011 Berry B J L, AOK, An Urban-Rural Happiness Gradient Urban Geography

Geography of European Life Satisfaction Social Indicators Research

Europeans Work To Live and Americans Live To Work (Who is Happy to Work More: Americans or Europeans?)

Journal of Happiness Studies

2010 Religiosity and Life Satisfaction Across Nations Mental Health, Religion & Culture

2009 Berry B J L, AOK, Dissatisfaction with City Life: A New Look at Some Old Questions Cities

EXTERNAL GRANTS

190k PLN (~\$50k) PI, "The effect of social transfers and social capital on happiness of elderly." Vistula University, Warsaw Poland, Polish National Science Foundation (Narodowe Centrum Nauki NCN) 2016/21/B/HS4/03058 .. 2017-2019

\$1.5k Consultant (summer salary), "Health information inequity in South Jersey-Vineland" South Jersey Institute for Population Health (SJIPH) Catalyst Grant <https://sjiph.org/projects/health-information-inequity-in-south-jersey-vineland> 2026

INTERNAL GRANTS (AWARDS and FELLOWSHIPS)

\$12k faculty advisor, Rutgers Camden chancellor's dissertation completion award for Marlo Rossi2026

\$30k faculty advisor, Rutgers Camden urban innovation fund grant to Ojobo Agbo Eje2024-2026

\$15k PI, Rutgers Camden chancellor's interdisciplinary research collaboration grant 2023-2024

\$1k Rutgers-Camden Research Council Grant Award 2016-2017

\$1k Rutgers-Camden Digital Teaching Fellow 2016-2017

\$4k Rutgers-Camden Rand Institute Faculty Fellow 2013-2014

\$1k Rutgers-Camden Civic Engagement Faculty Fellow 2013-2014

TEACHING (note curriculum development: [developed/designed] or [re-designed])

2025 recipient of department's Jay A Sigler award for "outstanding service and dedication to students" (awarded by students); the plaque says "this award is given to the faculty member who exhibits a commitment to student's academic development and personal growth."

GIS for data science <https://theaok.github.io/gisPy/> [developed/designed] 2023-present

Data Processing (data management for data science) <https://theaok.github.io/datManPy> [developed/designed] 2023-present

Data Visualization <https://theaok.github.io/vis> [developed/designed] 2023-present

Coping with Extremes: Ecological resilience & human well-being [innovative class co-taught with biology dept] [co-developed/designed] 2019

Community & WellBeing (Happiness and Place) [developed/designed]	2018-present
Data Management [developed/designed]	2016-present
GIS for Public Sector/Urban mapping [developed/designed]	2012-present
Quantitative Methods 2 [re-designed]	2013-2017, 2024
Research Methods [re-designed]	2012-present
Introduction to Regional and Economic Development [re-designed]	2012-2014
Quantitative Methods 1 [re-designed]	2012-2013

SERVICE

SERVICE TO THE FIELD/PROFESSION:

Review papers (approx 3-4/mo or 36-48/year as of Jan 2026; “top journals” underlined; starting in 2022: last 2 digits of year of review shown):

- <informal/for a colleague> [24]
- Acta Sociologica
- Applied Economics [23,23]
- Applied Research in Quality of Life [23,23,23,24,24,24,24,26]
- Basic and Applied Social Psychology [22]
- BMC Psychology [26]
- BMJ Open
- British Journal of Political Science [25]
- Cities [22,23,23,23,23,23,24,24,24,24,24,25,25,25,25,25,25,25,25]
- City, Culture and Society
- City, Territory and Architecture [24]
- Cogent Arts & Humanities [23]
- Cognition and Emotion
- Communications Psychology [23]
- Comparative Economic Studies [26]
- Discover Public Health [25,26]
- Ecological Economics [24]
- Environment and Planning A
- Economics and Politics
- European Journal of Social Psychology
- European Journal of Political Economy [23,23,24]
- European Societies
- European Urban and Regional Studies [22,22]
- Frontiers in Psychology [23]
- Global Transitions [24]
- Humanities and Social Sciences Communications [23,23,23,24,24,25,25]
- Heliyon [23,24]
- International Journal of Comparative Sociology [23,24,24,25]

- International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health
- International Journal of Psychology
- International Journal of Social Economics [22]
- International Journal of Wellbeing [25]
- International Perspectives in Psychology: Research, Practice, Consultation
- International Sociology
- Journal of Comparative Economics
- Journal of Contemporary Religion
- Journal of Economic Growth
- Journal of Economic Psychology
- Journal of Economic and Social Geography
- Journal of Personality and Social Psychology: Personality Processes and Individual Differences[16]
- Journal of Personality and Social Psychology: Attitudes and Social Cognition[26]
- Journal of Religion and Health
- Journal of Regional Science
- Journal of Happiness Studies [22,23,24,26,26,26]
- Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Management
- Journal of Public and Nonprofit Affairs
- Journal of Public Policy [23,23]
- Journal of the American Planning Association
- Journal of Urbanism
- Land Use Policy [23,24,24]
- Local Development and Society [25]
- Mental Health, Religion and Culture
- Millah: Journal of Religious Studies [25]
- Nature Communications [24]
- Open Psychology Journal
- Quality of Life Research
- Papers in Regional Science [22,22]
- PLOS ONE [22]
- Political Behavior [22]
- PNAS Nexus [24]
- Problems of Post-Communism [22]
- Psychology of Religion and Spirituality
- Public Administration Review [24,25]
- Regional Studies [22,22]
- Review of Political Economy
- Routledge (book publisher) [22]
- Rural Sociology [22]
- Urban Geography
- Urban Studies [25]
- Urban Affairs Review
- Utilities Policy [25,25]
- Science of the Total Environment

- Scientific Reports [24]
- Scienze Regionali Italian Journal of Regional Science
- Scientometrics [22,22]
- Semestre Economico (Universidad de Medellín) [22]
- Social Forces
- Social Psychological and Personality Science
- Social Indicators Research [as reviewer] [22,22,23,23,23,23,24,24,24,24,25,25,25,25,25]
- Social Indicators Research [as co-editor]¹ [25, 25, 25, 25, 25]
- Social Science And Medicine [24,24,25,25,25,25,25]
- Social Science Research [23]
- Social Sciences & Humanities Open [23]
- Sociological Spectrum
- Sociology of Religion
- Sustainability
- Sustainable Cities and Society
- Sustainable Futures [25]
- The Lancet Planetary Health (IF >10)
- Third World Quarterly [22,23]
- Wellbeing, Space & Society [22,25]

Reviewed books chapters:

- 3 chapters in “A Research Agenda for Happiness. Why we want to know, what we know, and what we want to know additionally.” Editors: Jan Ott and Ruut Veenhoven. Edward Elgar Publishing [26,26,26]

Reviewed books for:

- Routledge [22]
- Cambridge U Pr [23]

Served on editorial boards:

- Social Indicators Research: Associate Editor / Co-Editor² Jan 2024-??
- Political Behavior Jan-Dec 2019

Reviewed grant proposals:

- Polish National Science Foundation (NCN)
- Israel Science Foundation (ISF)

SERVICE TO STUDENTS:

Publications with students (all students unless indicated: “[not student]”):

9. AOK, L Martinez [not student], E Mikhaeil; Happy Colombia, Unhappy Bogota (urban-rural happiness gradient in Colombia) Wellbeing, Space and Society 2026
8. E Mikhaeil, AOK; Well-Being and the authoritarian welfare state: sector of employment and human happiness in Arab countries; Public Organization Review 2025

¹As a co-editor of Social Indicators Research, conducted through reviews (printed out, marked up, etc). Note: this is different from regular editing, where I just skim through the paper or read some parts only; and hence this extra work is listed here separately from editing as reviewing [starting oct2025 each such review marked with 2 last digits of year]

²This is not just sitting on the board of the journal and having an occasional board meeting, I am editing papers every week spending as of 2026 $1 + hrs/wk$ (earlier as i was less experienced it was $2 + hrs/wk$) on skimming through the submitted manuscripts, inviting reviewers, reading reviews, and making editorial decisions.

7. MJ D'Italia, AOK; Constructing General Human Agency Indicators (GHAls) and a General Personal Agency Scale (GPAS); Social Indicators Research 2025
6. E Mikhaeil, AOK; Public-private job satisfaction differential: The case of Egypt; Public Organization Review 2025
5. AOK, BK Everett, E Mikhaeil; Happiness is In The Air if It Grows (Growing Places are Happier than Shrinking ones); Urban Affairs Review 2024
4. E Mikhaeil, AOK; Subjective well-being and urbanization in Egypt; Cities 2024
3. S Deb, AOK; Exploring the association of urbanization and subjective well-being in India; Cities 2023
2. FA Abarghuie, R Javadi, E Mirabi, AOK; Experience of urban thermal pleasure: A qualitative study to the understanding of thermal-scape quality; Cities 2022
1. R Stansfield [not student], E Aaronson, AOK; Police use of firearms: Exploring citizen, officer, and incident characteristics in a statewide sample; Journal of criminal justice 2021

Supervised dissertations for [year of graduation, first job]:

8. Wei Chen [28??]
7. Erick W Udogu [27??]
6. Douglas N Zacher [27??]
5. Marlo Rossi [26??]
4. Michael D'Italia [24, RU-Camden] PDF
3. Shibin Yan [24, Walter Rand Institute for Public Affairs] PDF
2. Aditi Manke [21, Virginia Tech] PDF
1. Shourjya Deb [20, SIPRI] PDF

Supervised dissertations for less than the whole duration:

1. Helena Cabezas [Fall 25 only]

Served on dissertation committees:

10. Jason Schweitzer (Prevention Science) [27??]
9. Daniel Assamah [27??]
8. Monty Sanders [26??]
7. Brian Everett [27??]
6. Kate Cruz [22]
5. Charles Ian Hugh Forsyth (University of Otago NZ) [22]
4. Straso Jovanovski [19]
3. Spencer Clayton [18]
2. Rasheda Weaver [17]
1. Chris Wheeler [17]

Served on dissertation committees for less than the whole duration:

1. Yanan Li [stopped serving just before the proposal in 2023]

Supervised data science master thesis for [year of graduation]:

6. Nalluri Chandahas [26]
5. Bhavyani Dodda [25]
4. Thanvitha Reddy Munagala [25]
3. Pavan Satya Venigalla [25]
2. Het Rakeshbhai Patel [25]
1. Raman Srinivas Naik [25]

Served on master thesis committees in social science:

2. Ethan Aaronson (crim) [20]
1. Rachel Wagner (psy) [20]

Independent/Directed Study [starting in 2023 counts shown (2014-present)]:

- fa25 x1
- sp25 x4
- fa24 x7
- sp24 x2
- fa23 x1

Researchers/Predocs/Postdocs/Lab Members/Visiting Scholars:

- hired 2 data scientists (Sep 2025-Jul 2026)
- planning to host Visiting Scholar, Professor Leonie C. Steckermeier Fall 2026

DEPARTMENTAL AND CAMPUS-WIDE SERVICE:

At Rutgers-Camden served on the following departmental committees:

- Awards/Events, chair 2013-16, 2021-22; 2023-25
- Awards/Events, member 2012-13, 2019-20, 2023
- Strategic Planning, member 2019-20
- PR/Website, chair 2014-16
- PR/Website, member 2012-13
- PhD, member 2014-21
- Methods Qualifying Exam, member 2012-21

Other Rutgers-Camden departmental service:

- held dissertation seminars for a group of doctoral candidates (in addition to one-on-one) Fall 2025
- led Brown Bag Seminars 2018-19; 2023-24
- As co-editor of a journal organized “Publish or Perish” workshop Oct 2024

At Rutgers-Camden served on the following campus-wide committees:

- AI committee Fall 2025
- Advancement and Promotions (A&P), member/ad hoc chair 2020-25
- Advancement and Promotions (A&P), member 2018-19
- Faculty Senate 2018-25
- Faculty Life, chair 2019-22
- Faculty Life, member 2014-15

Other Rutgers-Camden campus-wide service:

- led creation and maintenance of data science lab and MS in data science and associated certificate programs 2018-22
- served as director for data science certificate: <https://graduateschool.camden.rutgers.edu/graduate-programs/#certificates> 2022-??
- organized Geographic Information System (GIS) workshop attended by faculty from across the campus <https://theaok.github.io/shortGIS/> 2017

COMMUNITY SERVICE

provided data management for:

- Ohio Business Round Table (contracted by Miami University, Ohio; Contract Amount: \$7,000) 2022
- 2018 Michigan Economic Competitiveness Study, Michigan Chamber of Commerce (contracted by Northwood University, Michigan; Contract Amount: \$5,000) 2018

assisted following Rutgers-Camden students in their community projects as a faculty advisor:

- data science MS Ojobo Agbo Eje: “Camden Health Equity Data Visualization Initiative” project: [click for news item] [hired/supervised 4 students, budget \$30k] 2024-26
- public affairs PhD Zach Chengcheng Yue at Walter Rand Institute: Covid-19 in Atlantic County ... Spring-Fall 2025
- public affairs PhD Marlo Rossi at Walter Rand Institute: Abortion in South Jersey; and other projects on abortion: [click for news item] Fall 2025-Spring 2026
- MPA Olorunfunmi Adebajo’s internship at the Camden County Community Development Office’s Homelessness Assistance Unit: [click for news item], 2024

other community service:

- made GIS maps dashboard (containing work by students in my GIS class): available on campus or via RU VPN only: <https://maps-dppa.camden.rutgers.edu/index.php?search=map&title=Special%3ASearch&profile=default&fulltext=1> 2019-23
- assisted Hunterdon Central Regional High School student: happiness paper class project Fall 2025-Spring 2026
- organized Geographic Information System (GIS) workshop for The Walter Rand Institute for Public Affairs <https://theaok.github.io/shortGIS/vShortGeoda.pdf> 2019

MOST FREQUENT RECENT CONFERENCES

LASA (Latin American Studies Association) 2024

AAG (American Association of Geographers): 2015, 2016, 2017, covid19/none,

ISQOLS (International Society for Quality of Life Studies): 2015, 2017, 2018, covid19/none, 2023, 2024 (webinar), 2026 (regional)

ERSA (European Regional Science Association): 2015, 2017, 2018, covid19/none, 2023

AFFILIATE SCHOLAR

- Australian Centre on Quality of Life (2016-present)
- CURE: Center for Urban Research and Education, Rutgers-Camden (2012-18)
- EHERO: Erasmus Happiness Economics Research Organization, Erasmus, the Netherlands (2013-16)
- Vistula University, Warsaw, Poland (2015-18)

1 Research

Since 2017, when I have submitted my materials for promotion to associate professor with tenure, I have published 36 peer reviewed articles, including 7 in *Cities*, a journal with impact factor (IF)=7.8, higher than widely considered the top journal in public administration in the US, *Public Administration Review* with IF=6.2.¹ Four articles are in *Social Indicators Research* (out of which 1 provisionally accepted/minor revisions), and 9 in *Applied Research in Quality of Life*, both leading/main journals in my field.

2 Teaching

I am 2025 recipient of the department's Jay A Sigler award for "outstanding service and dedication to students" (awarded by students); the plaque says "this award is given to the faculty member who exhibits a commitment to student's academic development and personal growth."

Since 2020, I graduated 4 PhDs, they all have a job. One is at SIPRI (Stockholm International Peace Research Institute), a think-tank ranked 11th or 31st worldwide.² Another one at Virginia Tech and the other 2 were employed at Rutgers when they graduated.

My students publish. Since 2020, I have published 10 peer-reviewed papers with my students (9 published and 1 provisionally accepted/minor revisions) in good journals including 3 in top ranked *Cities* with Impact Factor of 7.8.

I make sure I am available and approachable for students spending extra time outside of the classroom: working on papers, being accessible via zoom and in person, including when on sabbatical. Now in Spring 2026 I am on sabbatical, but I still have 4 students enrolled in my dissertation hours, and I work with others on papers.

One highlight is unusually heavy curriculum development. Since coming to Rutgers-Camden in 2012, I have taught over 10 different classes, developed from scratch most of them, including 3 courses in 2023 for our new data science program. I am updating my teaching materials each time I teach a class.

I strive to improve my teaching: I just attended cybersecurity training (most of my teaching is computer coding or data science—cybersecurity matters there), and attended Instructional Design and Technology (IDT) workshop on "Crafting the Learner-Centered Syllabus" in 2024. And I quite regularly read on teaching and mentoring advice, tips and tricks on *nature.com*, *chronicle.com*, and *insidehighered.com*.

One highlight is that the skills learned in my classes work in the real world:

The classes I took with you are helping not only my scholarship, but my day job. Thank you [...] I greatly appreciate it.

Subject: Received a Job Offer [...] I would like to thank you for all of the guidance and knowledge during all of your data-related courses the past several semesters to help me get to the point I am at today.

Since graduating I have continued to pursue more projects in the coding world. Some analysis projects, business models, and even some fun web apps and game designs. I appreciate all the help and motivation you gave me in class as it helped me to really see what I can come up with from

¹<https://www.scimagojr.com/journalsearch.php?q=16956&tip=sid> and <https://www.scimagojr.com/journalsearch.php?q=17167&tip=sid>

²<https://thinktankalert.com/rankings> and <https://guides.library.upenn.edu/c.php?g=1035991&p=7509972>

all of the useful tools, how to plan and build on projects, and skills gained from having you as my professor.

And students appreciate my approach and style:

I am reaching out to explore the possibility of having you as my graduate advisor. My experience in your Data Management course left a lasting impression on me and I appreciated your approach and teaching style. I believe your guidance would be invaluable in helping me navigate the academic journey towards finishing my doctoral degree.

This is Teacher Appreciation Week and I just wanted to take a moment to say thank you for all the hard work and dedication you put into teaching. Your passion for education has inspired and impacted me in so many ways. Your commitment to helping your students grow and learn is truly admirable. Thank you for all that you do!

Please know that I deeply appreciate everything you have done for me, and I recognize the many ways you have helped me grow as a scholar and, frankly, as an agentic person in general. I am truly grateful for you.

And my classes might have even contributed to retention in the program:

I have learnt so much about my region is really unbelievable and I have enjoyed working with you a lot. So much, I am actually considering STAYING in the program because of you!

3 Service

My service mostly builds on and derives from my main focus and strength, research. I provide such service in two main ways: 1) to the profession/scholarly field, and 2) to students.

I review about 3-4/mo or 36-48/year papers for journals, including the top journals such as Journal of Personality and Social Psychology and Public Administration Review (see CV for details).

Reviewing is an essential foundation of scholarly fields, and it is increasingly in short supply—something I can attest as a journal editor. Since January 2024, I co-edit Social Indicators Research, the leading journal in my field of quality of life and wellbeing. My editorial philosophy is to be mentor and helper, not just gate-keeper—for instance, I am often in favor of revision prior to external review, and I try to guide the authors, especially the junior ones.

My research-oriented service over past 6 years 2020-2026 to students is: published 10 peer-reviewed articles with students as co-authors (9 published and 1 provisionally accepted/minor revisions), supervised 8 dissertations (4 graduated; 4 in-progress), served on 6 dissertation committees, supervised 6 data science master theses, served on 2 master thesis committees in other social science, and supervised 15 independent studies. I have also led brown bag seminars and organized a workshop on academic publishing.

And I am very excited about bringing to campus an award winning junior professor from Germany as a visiting scholar for 2 months in Fall 2026: Leonie C. Steckermeier. Leonie is a productive scholar already benefiting 2 of our doctoral students—we have monthly or so zoom meetings where we are already working on papers.

I contribute service to the campus and department. Over 2018-2022 I have led the development of a new MS in data science and associated certificate program. This was a substantial undertaking and also somewhat challenging as the newly created programs are located outside of my home department. I have been serving since 2022 as a director for data science certificate.³

³See certificates at the bottom of the page: <https://graduateschool.camden.rutgers.edu/graduate-programs>.

I am currently supervising 2 courtesy appointments as volunteer researchers in the department—they work with me on research but also helped students in my class. I frequently serve as either ad hoc chair or member on the Advancement and Promotions (A&P) committee. I find this service fulfilling. I contribute to promoting quality faculty in our social sciences and I learn about my colleagues. Other committee service is enumerated in the CV.

While research-oriented service is my strength and passion, and usual campus and departmental service is my duty, I am also mindful of Rutgers-Camden public/community service/engagement mission. I agree that as a public university, we also need to engage with and provide service to the public and community. I have assisted a number of Rutgers-Camden students in their community projects over past 5 years serving as a faculty advisor for, for instance: Olorunfunmi Adebajo's internship at the Camden County Community Development Office's Homelessness Assistance Unit,⁴ Marlo Rossi's project at Walter Rand Institute and other projects on abortion,⁵ and Ojobo Agbo Eje: "Camden Health Equity Data Visualization Initiative."⁶

New Jersey first, but I have been civically engaged outside of the Garden State as well. For instance, I have used my data management skills to assist with data collection and management for Ohio Business Round Table, and Michigan Economic Competitiveness Study.

⁴Click for news item.

⁵Click for news item.

⁶Click for news item.

1 Research

The near future trajectory goal remains similar: ≥ 3 papers per year in good journals. In addition to European and North American focus I plan to add Latin American focus. I plan to spend more time on grant writing as I plan to grow my research group, hire students and post-docs, and do course buy-outs.

2 Teaching

My feature teaching preference would be to continue with the classes I have already taught, and there are plenty of them, over 10. My strength and preference is data science classes, but also happiness class that aligns with my research. I have been also developing a new class “social indicators” that would be broader than just happiness and include topics such as trust, freedom, and meaning. This would also align with my editorial position at Social Indicators Research journal.

I am interested in teaching short courses / micro-credentials. I have already taught a short GIS course (<https://theaok.github.io/shortGIS/>) twice, informally, for my colleagues from the department and other faculty from Arts and Sciences, and for Walter Rand Institute. But I would like to teach more often and other short courses. There is an initiative to create micro-credentials and Digital Badges—I would like to participate in it.

3 Service

In the ideal world, I would like to continue with research-oriented service. In particular, I would like to increase my research group and co-author more with students, and ideally postdocs. Chairing more dissertations and leading more independent studies would also be my strength and preference. I’m happy to take on more administrative duties such as co-editing another journal.

Additional comments:

On the face of it this is a good record. However, there are underlying problems with Adam's performance. Specifically, Adam has been very contentious in his interactions with faculty in the department. He has threatened to sue 3 faculty members in the department. His threats have strained working relationships in the department. This makes it extremely difficult for Adam to work with faculty members at lower ranks; at the same rank, but with fewer years of service; and even full professors. Adam also threatened to hold up a PhD student's proposal over a methodological dispute with the committee chair.

Teaching: As a result of Adam's behavior, I have only one full professor that Adam has not threatened. I assigned this professor to conduct Adam's peer observation. Adam resisted allowing the faculty member to conduct the observation and delayed the process.

After multiple email exchanges, Adam finally complied with the classroom observation. However, he sent an email to the observer prior to the observation stating:

Pls don't disturb the class or interrupt or say anything in the class.

I'm happy to have this visitation in the spirit of collegiality, but please note I have concerns about your evaluations from the past as non-factual, unreasonable, and unfair.

Also please note you are not my mentor, and I'm not trying to learn anything from you.

This behavior is unacceptable. Adam needs to collaborate with the peer observers in the department. He also needs to reflect on the feedback provided and develop an action plan for improvement in areas identified by the observer.

In addition, student comments on Adam's SIRS reports indicate that his approach to teaching could be more organized. Sample comments include (see attachment for comprehensive list):

- This course needs a clear and complete syllabus as well as clear assignment instructions and an overall grading scale or rubrics for each assignment.
- Provide students with a grading rubric and clear expectations. Provide clear instructions for assignments.
- Better organize the syllabus and slides
- Needs to be better organized
- Not having a clear syllabus document and one central course page on one platform made it extremely hard to keep track of class assignments and progress
- Course needs a structured, organized Canvas site; the course website is confusing and difficult to navigate.

I recommend that Adam make an appointment with Camden IDT to get assistance with revising his syllabi and building effective Canvas sites for his courses.

I previously spoke with Adam about the following courses: GIS, Data Management, and Data Visualization. Adam has pivoted to using only Python in these courses. His rationale is as follows:

- “Python is the future of coding, QGIS may disappear”
- He can’t teach 2 different methods in the same class
- When DPPA and data science courses are cross-listed, he goes with the majority of students (e.g., data science)
- Since these courses are electives, he doesn’t see the need to make adjustments.

His syllabi use the following phrases:

- students need to have “the ability to learn basic coding”
- “if you have difficulty using a computer, this class is not for you”
- “warning if you can’t learn simple coding in Python, this class is not for you.

This language does not create a welcoming environment for DPPA students. Although, he previously used QGIS for the course GIS in the Public Sector and Stata for the MPA/Public Affairs version of Data Management, he stated he will no longer provide alternatives to Python in these courses. He also stated that Data Visualization is all Python.

This approach poses problems because it makes his courses inaccessible to some of our DPPA students. Adam seems indifferent to their needs. Lengthier comments from SIRS include:

Research Methods Fall 2021

There was absolutely no encouragement for intellectual growth and progress. If you did not come up with what the professor would have for an assignment you got an extremely poor grade with little or unhelpful feedback. Most other professors grade problem sets based on completion and effort and give helpful feedback for later, larger and graded assignments (i.e. midterms and finals).

Spending hours on complicated and unclear problem sets and reviewing them multiple times to ensure all questions were answered and then getting 3/10 grades is extremely discouraging and extremely unhelpful. This course is also the course that leads into our capstone projects but in this class we had no freedom in our research approaches and were only being taught extremely numerical, statistical, and quantitative methods with no mention of or real option for other very important research methods especially for those on the community development track.

The course materials on the professors private website were so disorganized and hard to follow. Having to look for an unclear and unorganized syllabus one place and then having to submit our assignment another place (Canvas) and then access dropbox on Sakai for feed back was extremely confusing and frustrating. Not having a clear syllabus document and one central course page on one platform made it extremely hard to keep track of class assignments and progress and to stay motivated as a person who needs structure to be successful. I have never experienced anything like this and it was extremely frustrating and stressful to navigate. It was such a shame this was the experience in this class as this is an extremely important course in our program and for our capstone.

Data Management Fall 2023

I wanted to be excited for this course, but he made it unapproachable and painful. He seemed to assume the answers to students' questions were obvious and would say "look at my notes" when students requested clarification. His notes were extremely minimal and often vague. I don't know if it occurs to him that the material he's teaching is not intuitive to people who haven't coded before. Frankly the course should not be offered to those who do not already have experience with python.

This instructor needs to learn basic pedagogy. I cannot overstate that. I never learned from a single lecture and I found office hours unhelpful as well. The instructor's communication skills and teaching skills in general make him difficult to approach. I eventually gave up on trying. Everything that I learned from this course I did on my own time by talking to graduate students in the computer science program. I have never left a review this negative before for an instructor. I am uncomfortable stating all of this, but I think it needs to be said. I would never have taken this course if I knew how it was run. I would actively discourage other students from taking this course unless it changes drastically.

Adam has been very dedicated to teaching the data science classes, but he seems indifferent to the needs of DPPA students. In addition to consulting with IDT, I recommend that Adam work with Bill Fitzgerald and other teaching mentors on the Camden Campus to address the issues highlighted above.

I would like to see Adam make a stronger contribution to teaching in his home department. Specifically, it would be helpful to have Adam take responsibility for the Regional and Economic Development course in the MS/PhD program and possibly one of the core PhD courses.

Service: Although Adam's service to the discipline and the Camden campus is good, I would like to see a stronger level of service to the department. Several DPPA faculty members have heavy service loads as program and center directors. As a result, we need Adam to take a stronger role in supporting the department. In his previous service on the Public Affairs committee with comprehensive exams, he submitted questions that had been posted online and could not be used. He appeared to put little time or effort into his work on the MS/PHD committee.

There are opportunities to take on a greater leadership role in several areas, including:

- Advising doctoral students
- Guiding dissertations and working collaboratively with other committee members
- Assisting the department with:
 - data dashboards
 - graduation rates for students,
 - data collection,
 - assisting with data from affiliated centers
- Workshops for PhD Students
- Data Mentoring

In his current role as Chair of the Awards and Events Committee, Adam needs to pay more attention to details. For example, in organizing the practice sessions for students participating in the UAA conference, he needs to clearly communicate the expectations and details of the practice sessions and coordinate multiple email reminders.

In the past, Adam has been enthusiastic about organizing brown bag presentations with graduate students. It would be helpful for him to re-engage with this practice. This aligns with his role as chair of the Awards & Events Committee. As noted above, he needs to take initiative in scheduling and communicating expectations/details of the events with faculty and graduate students.

Research: Although this is a good record, there is room for improvement in a variety of areas. In terms of research, Adam's research on cities would have more added value if he could speak to what leads to or causes unhappiness in cities. For example, is it density, diversity, or something else? What are the policy implications? In addition, it would be helpful to secure external grants and leverage internal grants/awards to fund his research, especially his Colombia project. It would also be helpful to have a clearer explanation of what his future research plans are.

5.1.2 My response to post-tenure Patrice evaluation

Some of it is constructive/useful as elaborated later, but much of it is not.¹ And it's not factual and lacking objectivity. It's an unhelpful and negative take—I asked Patrice (dept chair) to rewrite, but she didn't, so I respond below. Excuse me being bringing up negative things, but I did not bring those up first, just responding here.

1 Unhappy Department

The main criticism is I don't get along and keep on suing people. I'm actually shocked they² bring it up, they should be ashamed and keep it quiet, but since they brought it up, let me respond. What happened here is that Gloria offered \$5k for a workshop for her staff, I did the workshop, she didn't pay, so I told her I'll have to sue, then she paid.³ End of story. Why even bring this up? What did I do wrong? I'd be wrong if I didn't sue. And no hard feelings, stuff happens, let's move on. Then suing Mike: he signed merit pay evaluation that's non-factual, it said I "underperform" in "research", while I can prove I over-perform (see later towards the end under research)—again looks like a clear case to me to sue. Why not? Any reasonable person would do the same.⁴ I could elaborate more,⁵ but again why you even bring this up? If anything it puts Gloria in bad light, not me. What did you think would happen here?⁶

"Adam also threatened to hold up a PhD student's proposal over a methodological dispute with the committee chair."—yes! It was a poor dissertation. I did my job. What's strange is that Paul kicked me out of the committee, as opposed to fix the dissertation.

Teaching evaluation that I wasn't cooperating with. Paul got this idea that he is my mentor and that I need his advice. He doesn't know much about my research area and giving me bad advice (instrumental variables etc). I'm trying to steer away from him, doesn't work, he needs to force his way. Paul doesn't take it well that I don't listen to his unhelpful research advice. He retaliates by giving me bad teaching evaluation.⁷

¹Still, I find this post-tenure review useful as it hopefully results in better communication and clearer expectations.

²By "they" I mean Gloria and Patrice—as far as I can tell Gloria really runs the department, not Patrice.

³If I made stuff up, then she probably would not pay, but she did pay. But if there are any slightest doubts on what happened, please let me know and let's dig deeper here. And of course, it was last resort, I did ask first several times for payment.

⁴Again, of course, last resort, I did ask several times to fix this. And then here I actually backed off for 2 reasons—I had a good conversation with the dean who convinced me it's not necessary to sue, and 2) I felt bad for Mike because I'm pretty sure it wasn't him behind this fake evaluation—it was most likely Gloria behind the scenes, Mike just signed it. But keep on pushing me and I will sue. We can go that way. It's ridiculous you even bring this up. Finally, Patrice says I threatened to sue 3 people. No. I think she means one email I sent to her, but I didn't mean her, but Mike who signed the evaluation, and effectively Gloria who was most likely behind the scenes. So it's really just about one person, Gloria.

⁵"Adam has been very contentious in his interactions with faculty"—I fit right in, everyone is. "threatened to sue 3 faculty members"—no, just one, just Gloria, but she settled so we are all good from my side. No hard feelings. Gloria also seemed to have made Mike sign poor merit pay evaluation for me, so I had to threaten lawsuit there, but it's all about Gloria behind the scenes. And Patrice misunderstood one email, it wasn't about her, but about Gloria. "His threats have strained working relationships in the department."—how? Gloria wasn't talking to me anyway—I haven't strained any relationship with Gloria—it never existed. "This makes it extremely difficult to for Adam to work with faculty members at lower ranks; at the same rank, but with fewer years of service; and even full professors."—I don't think me suing Gloria has anything to do with me working with others, especially junior folks. If anything people should appreciate me seeking justice. There's actually just one junior person, Cint, and we do get along. Clint invited me to be on his grant, we got it, and will be doing reseaaarch together. It's opposite, it's most difficult to work with full professors in DPPA, not junior. Patrice blames toxic department on me—it was toxic long before I threatend to sue. Suing one person has little to do with other persons, if anything at all. And suing is a good way to seek fairness/justice, which we badly lack in DPPA—if anything I should get award, not be blamed.

⁶I guess it was meant to scare me or something or make me more docile and do what I'm told, like later under Service Patrice says I should work for free for Gloria's and Steve's centers if I understood correctly. But no, I won't be pushed around. But while I have my boundaries, at the same time, I am super friendly, I study happiness after all. Come on DPPA let's move on and let's get along, let's have a beer and smoke a cigar together:)

⁷I was trying to avoid Paul doing the evaluation—I felt like he's after me. And I had bad experience from past when he would oppose me going up to full unless I listen to his research advice so I'd protest: "Paul is not reasonable neither fair in his evaluations," to which he responds "You are charming as always. This evaluation will happen one way or another." Why not just let it go and why being so stubborn to evaluate me? Another reason for not having Paul evaluate my teaching: he had this questionable PhD qualifying exam that was counterproductive for students, so I had at a time a political action/petition with students going on against Paul's cheerished exam. I knew he was rather angry with me upending his favorite exam, so I went to Patrice and explained that there is conflict of interest: I am rallying up students against Paul's favorite exam, and you have Paul evaluate my teaching. Patrice brushed it off. Patrice could have done evaluation herself, could have chosen another associate professor. Actually I did find a great evaluator myself, Bill Fitzgerald from Teaching Matters—Bill did agree to do the evaluation. Again, no, it had to be Paul. Yet another reason I gave to Patrice: the class I was teaching was outside of Paul's expertise, and you'll see in attached evaluation in appendix that Paul didn't understand much of the class. Last but not least, I wouldn't be sure 100% from all of this that Paul was indeed retailaiting. But I did confront him after evaluation, I met him in person and told him I felt it was like retaliation, that you were going after me. His face went red. I actually didn't fully expect it! I thought maybe I was overthinking and being paranoid. I mean we're all human, Paul is a good person in general I guess, but come on, really? This is the kind of stuff we have going on in DPPA.

2 Teaching

"Adam has been very dedicated to teaching the data science classes, but he seems indifferent to the needs of DPPA students."—fundamentally, there is a cross-department conflict here: Patrice does not want me to teach data science students. But data science is my strength and we have a new data science program that I am contributing to—I don't think I should be penalized for supporting another program. Importantly, the good news now for even most coding-averse DPPA students is AI that can write the code for them, so it should be all fixed (as of 2025 seems to be great), but let's revisit in some time what's best for students.

In teaching section Patrice cherry picks negative student evaluations out of mostly positive ones. To be sure, I did take those into account long time ago when I saw them—fixed up Canvas, organized better. I do take teaching seriously.

And I strive to improve my teaching—no need for Patrice to tell me that. For instance, I just attended cybersecurity trainings⁸, and attended Instructional Design and Technology (IDT) workshop on "Crafting the Learner-Centered Syllabus" in 2024. And I quite regularly read on teaching and mentoring advice, tips and tricks on [nature.com](https://www.nature.com), [chronicle.com](https://www.chronicle.com), and [insidehighered.com](https://www.insidehighered.com).

3 Service

"I would like to see a stronger level of service to the department"—I heard that 3 years ago when department denied support for my promotion due to poor departmental service⁹—so I asked what else can I do for the department. I did everything I was asked to do, and more, I did extra things I wasn't asked (see CV for my service details), in fact I went to Patrice every semester to check on service. Last year, on 2025-10-20 Mon, I met with Patrice, I went over my service from my CV, and she did say "the service is ok"¹⁰ No comments.

Just briefly to respond to the things Patrice says I should be doing. "There are opportunities to take on a greater leadership role in several areas, including:"

- "Advising doctoral students" "Guiding dissertations and working collaboratively with other committee members"—that's funny! I supervise 5. The departmental recommendation is 3. So there is no thanks for going above and beyond, and apparently I don't do enough. In addition I am supervising master theses in Data Science, and I do many independent studies—in fact I think I'm doing more than anybody else in the department here. Over past 6 years 2020-2026, supervised 9 dissertations (4 graduated; 5 in-progress), served on 6 dissertation committees, supervised 6 data science master theses, served on 2 master thesis committees in other social sciences, and supervised 15 independent studies.
- "Assisting the department with: data dashboards, graduation rates for students, data collection"—that sounds like institutional research, not a part of my job description.
- "assisting with data from affiliated centers"—Patrice seems to ask that I work for Gloria's and Steve's centers apparently for free. I don't believe it's in my job description. However, I'm always happy to do paid consulting. (Gloria would have to pay upfront to avoid problems from the past).
- "Workshops for PhD Students"—I do those occasionally, e.g., "Publish or Perish—how to publish" and did GIS workshop. I was doing regularly brown bags, but Patrice told me we don't need them, now apparently she changed her mind, so happy to do those again.
- "Data Mentoring"—I don't know what that means, I guess that's what I do in my classes and with students that I advise, I don't see where else I should be doing it.

⁸2026 KnowBe4 Security Awareness Training, Cybersecurity Essentials: Secure Passwords, and Introduction to IT Security Policies—these enhance my classroom teaching—most of my courses involve computer coding or data science—cybersecurity matters more there than in usual social science courses.

⁹Which was also surprising at the time as I was doing what I was asked to do. But I thought then maybe I need to be more pro-active, don't wait to be told what to do, and do extra things. I also promised myself that this won't happen again, and I focused on service over past 3 years (see CV) at the cost to my research—I was devastated my research has suffered (research is my main thing, the reason I'm in academia) but I thought at least I'm sure I have fixed my service. But here we go again!

¹⁰I am 100% sure I wrote it down along with the date.

"he submitted questions that had been posted online and could not be used."—Paul did the same, i.e., used published papers in exam questions. I might have occasionally used/re-used questions from the past—my understanding is that it's fine as long as it is not all of the questions and not from prior year. "He appeared to put little time or effort into his work on the MS/PHD committee."—I am efficient and productive.

4 Research

My favorite section. "There is room for improvement"—wow. I was asked not to compare and not to be personal, so no names, just overall department stats.

Research impact or visibility is commonly measured with citations, and I am the most cited person in the department, by large margin. As of May 11 2026, I'm cited exactly 2x the second best person in the department this year.

Quantity of research output is measured at [researchwithrutgers.com](https://www.researchwithrutgers.com)—both at research units/department level and employee level. The department (research unit: Graduate School, Camden: Public Policy and Administration) has 10 employees.¹¹ Over the years 2019-2022¹² the 10 employees of the department have produced 37 research outputs,¹³ out of which 17 were mine,¹⁴ i.e., I have produced about half of the 10 person unit's output.¹⁵

2023-May 2026, the department has produced 33 outputs, out of which 13 are mine—I have been burdened with unfair amount of service over past 3 years, but still I have produced 40% of the department's output.

Visibility (and arguably quality and competitiveness) of the research output can be measured as Impact Factor (IF). As far as I can tell from quick search, there are only 2 people in this 10-person department that consistently publish in high impact journals, I am one of them. Since 2017, when I have submitted my materials for promotion to associate professor with tenure, I have published 37 peer-reviewed articles, including 7 in *Cities*, a journal with impact factor (IF)=8.1.

And the department chair tells me "there is room for improvement." I would refrain from further comments to end it on a positive note.

5 Conclusion and Discussion

It's time for new blood and new leadership in DPPA. I would like to volunteer to be a department chair. This department can do well.¹⁶

Or at least let's capitalize on my research strengths. I see myself as a research leader in the department—I'm not only productive myself in research, but also I lead the students in research. My students publish.¹⁷ I would like take on more leadership in research, for instance, I would like to take students to ISQOLS conference.¹⁸ I could also take on more administrative roles, for instance take the lead of the PhD program (if we can agree to focus more on science and less on activism).

I offer many more ideas in the section below.

¹¹<https://www.researchwithrutgers.com/en/organisations/public-policy-and-administration/persons/>

¹²I took these from my merit pay which I wrote Nov15 2023.

¹³<https://www.researchwithrutgers.com/en/organisations/public-policy-and-administration/publications>

¹⁴<https://www.researchwithrutgers.com/en/persons/adam-okulicz-kozaryn/publications/>

¹⁵Of course, the measure is crude and simplistic as it doesn't differentiate research output's length and quality. Still, it is remarkable that over 4 years one person has produced as much as other 9 people. And on quality, too, as measured by Impact Factor of journals, there are only 2 people in the department publishing in high impact journals, I am one of them.

¹⁶Let's have more democracy, where non-full professors' voices are heard. Let's make sure people can grow, and pursue their own path. For instance, let's capitalize on my data science strength in teaching—we already started doing that and let's continue. I'm better fit to teach data science than regional economic development or quantitative methods that should be modernized and redesigned towards data science. I can make the case that data science (and Python, not Qgis or Stata) is the future and benefits our students. I am mindful of the fact that some DPPA students have struggled in the past, but now with AI that should not be a problem anymore.

¹⁷Since 2020, we have published 10 peer-reviewed papers with my students in good journals including 3 in top ranked *Cities* with Impact Factor of 8.1. I co-edit *Social Indicators Research*—this also benefits our students—I have mentored 2 students to publish in the journal, and I involve the students also in the reviewing process for the journal.

¹⁸We should not prioritize the UAA conference—our research strengths do not lie there.

6 Questions to Patrice and Answers **TODO:** read from latex! and add answers from the talk

- Who wrote it? Gloria? Someone else? Just you or with input from someone? If so who?¹⁹ A: ""
- Can we agree to have factual, evidence-based evaluations?²⁰ A: ""
- I am also happy to be consulted and asked questions ahead of the evaluation, if anything is unclear? A: ""
- Can you also please respect conflict of interest for the future? Even perceived or potential only? Like with Paul's teaching evaluation. A: ""
- We need more social connection in the department. We could have more faculty mixers, or just informal faculty outings? I am happy to organize the latter. A: ""
- You are not a serious person—you did say my service was good, now you flipped. Do you remember you did say, on 2025-10-20 Mon: "the service is ok"?²¹²² A: ""
- Why would I do any service for dept, if no matter what I do I always get bad evaluation? A: ""
- I've been told for 14 years that I'm here what to do and I always agreed to everything (and still it isn't good enough), I think it is time for some initiative from my side and assertivness. Agreed? A: ""
- No, I cannot do UAA pre-presentations, I can do ISQOLS pre-presentations, that's where our reseach strength is. Agreed? A: ""
- I can also do brown-bags, great you do not oppose to these anymore. You do remember you did oppose to those? A: ""
- I don't think we need events/awards committee—it doesn't do much good, and what good it does is handled by Mike, you, and Lisa anyway. My role doesn't do much, just bureaucracy and unnecessary meetings. I was ok to chair it to make you happy, but apparently it didnt work, so why keep on doing that?²³ A: ""
- Processing student data and doing stats for the dept is not a part of my job, that's institutional research. Agreed? A: ""
- You seem to be suggesting I do unpaid data work for Gloria's and Steve's centers? I don't believe it's in my job description either, do you? A: ""
- I am happy to do paid data consulting. Or be part of grants, like with Clint. Don't you think it is a good idea? A: ""
- What workshops for PhDs do you have in mind (beyond brown bags)? For instance, I could do workshops on publishing, GIS, and maybe especially "finding the right data" may be most useful? Can we find some money for those in the budget? We could also perhaps split with other departments? A: ""
- I can do more administrative work for the department. Can I be a chair? A: ""
- I can also head PhD? Can we agree to focus on science, not activism? A: ""
- Teaching—we have AI, now even least able people can write code, so Python is actually easier than Stata or Qgis, lets revisit next year how it goes? A: ""

¹⁹I don't think it's Patrice only.

²⁰This is the root cause of the disagreement with me that the evaluations are not factual.

²¹I am 100% sure I wrote it down along with the date.

²²Now you just said: ""I would like to see a stronger level of service to the department," that is, I do not do enough for the dept.

²³More importantly, now I just have too much other meaningful service to afford doing wasteful service: dissertations, MS theses, independent studies, visiting professor, AP committee, etc—see CV.

- Do you want me to make the case for Python? A: ""
- Also, can we redesign PhD towards data science, so it fits better our faculty? For instance, let's drop Regional Economic Development and make a data science class required? A: ""
- We can also redesign QM1 and QM2 towards data science and can I teach those? Or replace QM1 with data visualization at least? A: ""
- Teaching-Canvas and syllabi were made perfectly clear long time ago, anything else? Want to have a look if anything missing there? You can get back with me later. A: ""
- Reseach-Did you read my papers? Which ones? A: ""
- Or Paul wrote this part of evaluation? He didn't read my papers either—they say what affects happiness in cities, and there are policy implications. Or do I miss something? A: ""
- Don't you think it's problematic for people who do not do academic research to evaluate academic research? How would you know if it's good or bad? A: ""
- Especially, that you claim to be reading my research? Why would you read it (as opposed to just look at scientometrics)? How would you know how to evaluate it? A: ""
- How come my research is not evaluated as exceeding expectations? What are the expectations? A: ""
- What is missing? Is the topic bad? Or bad journals? A: ""
- Should I be doing something full professors in the department do in terms of research? A: ""

7 Appendix: Paul's teaching evaluation and my response

Rutgers University-Camden
Department of Public Policy and Administration
Faculty Peer Evaluation of Classroom Teaching

Course:

- 56:219:521 DATA VISUALIZATION (dat sci)
- 56:824:728 DATA VISUALIZATION (soc sci/pub pol)
- 56:834:653 DATA VISUALIZATION (soc sci/pub pol)

Instructor: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn **Date Evaluated:** April 3, 2025

Note: Given the long time elapsed since the class observation, I supplemented my notes by watching the class video.

1. Subject of Class:

1) visualization techniques for data clustering, e.g. dendrograms and k-means scatterplots, 2) annotation of graphs using matplotlib, 3) “flipped classroom” to respond to student questions about a problem set.

2. Relevance of the subject to the course:

The content was appropriate to a course on data visualization, touching on important methods for representing clusters and relationships in data.

3. A. Was an assignment made: Yes _____ No ☒

Although no new assignment was introduced during the session, students appeared engaged with an assignment from the prior week and came prepared to discuss it.

B. Were students prepared: Yes ☒ No _____

4. Clarity of the ideas presented:

The description of the class as given to the students:

[apr3] clustering

a bit similar to previous scatterplots; clustering is about grouping / finding patterns, and very much data sciency!

we only scratch the surface here--just few popular vis for clustering;
i don't cover here the method, algorithms etc

Adam worked systematically through the material, alternating between code demonstrations in an online notebook and examples. The examples were presented clearly, but the presentation would have benefited from stronger substantive and conceptual framing. For example, the class could have explored more explicitly when to use a dendrogram versus a scatterplot with k-means clustering. For another, an “elbow plot” was presented as diagnostic for k-means clustering, but there was no explanation of what the plot represented, only that it tells you then ideal number of groups (based on what?). Without more grounding, the different types of visualizations are just black boxes.

While links to more in-depth discussion of the visualizations in relevant textbooks were provided, they lacked specific guidance (e.g., chapters or sections), which may make it difficult for students to locate the relevant material.

5. Manner of delivery:

Adam put students at ease and was very responsive to student questions. He made good use of examples, both simple examples using a small dataset followed by more complete examples using graphics from published papers.

6. Effective use of teaching aide(s), if they apply:

Rather than a whiteboard or PowerPoint slides, Adam used an online coding notebook, an environment for writing and executing code. This is an appropriate format given the material and the emphasis on coding. However, the notebook’s structure—one long, cumulative document covering several classes—made it difficult to follow at times, as his frequent scrolling up and down through the long document disrupted the flow. Segmenting the material into separate notebooks for each class or adding clearer section headings could improve clarity and pacing.

7. Student participation: The students were engaged throughout and asked appropriate questions. Adam had a good rapport with the students. When students sought deeper conceptual explanations (e.g., how clustering algorithms work), the responses could have gone beyond general descriptions to help students better understand the mechanics and assumptions of these techniques.

8: Other comments:

The syllabus and class notes would benefit from more careful organization and editing. Clearer structure, proofreading, and a consistent format would strengthen the professional presentation of the course materials and better reflect the high standards of our program.

More broadly, the course could be enhanced by integrating theoretical and design-oriented perspectives on data visualization—topics such as perception, cognition, and design principles. These form the intellectual foundation of the field and help students make informed decisions about how to represent data effectively and truthfully.

Adam’s course provides strong coding content and fosters an open, interactive learning

environment. The main opportunities for improvement lie in strengthening conceptual foundations, improving the organization and clarity of course materials, and ensuring that design and communication principles are integrated alongside technical skills. These adjustments would make the class more rigorous and balanced, aligning it more closely with the best practices in data visualization pedagogy. Without that, students may learn *how* to make various chart but not *why* certain choices communicate data more truthfully or effectively.

Paul A. Jorgensen

Visitor: _____

Date: 11/11/2025 Instructor: Bob Olin-Kay Date: _____
nov21 2025

Acceptance or comments:

The evaluation was helpful as it made me realize that my html bullet points didn't render and thus obscured readability; and it got me thinking about spending less time on code as AI takes over. Other than that the evaluation was unhelpful. I would like to raise several issues so that we can do better in the future.

Paul does not teach Python or data visualization. Neither does he use Python in his research. I was arguing to have someone else evaluate my teaching. I even found a replacement to do evaluation. Then I can't get the evaluation for 7 months (class was in April, I get evaluation in November) despite multiple emails and reminders. And then evaluation is mostly unhelpful as outlined below with my inline responses.

"the presentation would have benefited from stronger substantive and conceptual framing. "

It's a data visualization class, not math or algorithms class.

"an "elbow plot" was presented as diagnostic for k-means clustering, but there was no explanation of what the plot represented, only that it tells you then ideal number of groups (based on what?). Without more grounding, the different types of visualizations are just black boxes."

That's the whole point of the "elbow plot" to tell the number of groups. Again, it's a data visualization class, not math or algorithms class.

"While links to more in-depth discussion of the visualizations in relevant textbooks were provided, they lacked specific guidance (e.g., chapters or sections), which may make it difficult for students to locate the relevant material."

No. There is a reference to a specific chapter: "and especially machine learning ch: <https://jakevdp.github.io/PythonDataScienceHandbook/05.00-machine-learning.html>"

"the notebook's structure—one long, cumulative document covering several classes—made it difficult to follow at times, as his frequent scrolling up and down through the long document disrupted the flow. Segmenting the

material into separate notebooks for each class or adding clearer section headings could improve clarity and pacing."

There are not only section headings, but there are 3 levels of them: chapters, sections, and sub-sections (and I even police this in students' assignments—I take points off if students don't use sections).

"Clearer structure, proofreading, and a consistent format would strengthen the professional presentation of the course materials and better reflect the high standards of our program."

I was trying to discuss and get a sense of what Paul means here but I wasn't able to get detailed or specific information. As far as I can tell it's about writing style: Paul is traditional and formal. And I'm quite the opposite: modern, straightforward, and informal.

My materials have a clear structure and consistent format. I actually have a specific philosophy here to be straightforward and informal. I follow Zinnser's "On Writing Well: The Essential Guide to Mastering Nonfiction Writing and Effective Communication." For instance: "Never say anything in writing that you wouldn't comfortably say in conversation. If you're not a person who says "indeed" or "moreover," or who calls someone an individual ("he's a fine individual"), please don't write it." I was asking Paul for reference to his style, but I didn't get any.

I even wrote a paper on cluttered and ornamented grandiose prose in social science as compared to natural science: <https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s11192-012-0937-9>

So called social science "professional presentation" in writing can typically actually obscure meaning and communication. Again, following Zinnser, the goal should be simplicity and readability.

Per "high standards of our program"—i think my teaching has a good standard, e.g., my current students publish in good journals: https://theaok.github.io/okulicz_kozaryn_cv.pdf#page=6

And, what do we mean by "high standards of our program"? Is it formal traditional writing? Does such writing translate into desired outcomes, i.e. communication and learning? (especially in methods/coding classes). These are ever more relevant questions as we are increasingly over-burdened by information. Clarity, simplicity, and readability seem a way to go.

"More broadly, the course could be enhanced by integrating theoretical and design-oriented perspectives on data visualization—topics such as perception, cognition, and design principles. These form the intellectual foundation of the field and help students make informed decisions about how to represent data effectively and truthfully. Adam's course provides strong coding content and fosters an open, interactive learning environment. The main opportunities for improvement lie in strengthening conceptual foundations, improving the organization and clarity of course materials, and ensuring that design and communication principles are integrated alongside technical skills. These adjustments would make the class more rigorous and balanced, aligning it more closely with the best practices in data visualization pedagogy. Without that, students may learn how to make various chart but not why certain choices communicate data more truthfully or effectively."

These were covered in the course earlier. The class was geared towards the students, not towards the visitation, i.e. the visited Apr3 class was not self-contained, it did not include important elements included in other classes.

I did reach out to Paul to discuss, build bridges, and understand each other better. We had 2 discussions, somewhat helpful, but still I was not able to get enough details and specificity. I got a sense that it is time to wrap up, hence my lengthy response above. For the future, I am hoping we can agree to disagree and work out constructive compromises.

The evaluation was also helpful in a sense that I watched the class video and noted I could have had a little more eye contact and walk around more and be less on the monitor. But again as outlined above most of the evaluation is unhelpful--I hope in the future we can be more constructive. I am excited to discuss and collaborate on teaching. I think we could focus more on teaching.

Rev. 1/12

5.2 Research

5.2.1 Notes/Footnotes

note: this book is excluded from the promotion packet (this is a popular science book): Happiness and Place: Cities v Nature. Why Life is Better Outside of the City? Palgrave Macmillan

I am collegial and collaborative—I've coauthored with over 20 authors (Scopus): <https://www.scopus.com/authid/detail.uri?authorId=23061538900#tab=co-authors>

5.2.2 Elaboration On My Research

5.2.3 Scientometrics

As per Google Scholar https://scholar.google.com/citations?hl=en&user=pz9RYloAAAAJ&view_op=list_works&sortby=pubdate: I have more than doubled my citations since 2017, when I have submitted my materials for promotion to associate professor with tenure, from 163 to 353 in 2025.

According to Scopus <https://www.scopus.com/authid/detail.uri?authorId=23061538900>: I have had about 4 indexed publications per year since 2017, and also my citations more than doubled between 2017 and 2025.

5.3 Teaching

address low swb class eval bc on angela like cp paste all verbal stuff from 3 students incl 2 paraguay, and from my response to patrice; see notes in n.oorg in tenure/assoc-to-full

5.4 Letters from students

One highlight is that the skills learned in the classes work in the real world: “The classes I took with you are helping not only my scholarship, but my day job. Thank you [...] I greatly appreciate it.” and “subject:Received a Job Offer [...] I would like to thank you for all of the guidance and knowledge during all of your data-related courses the past several semesters to help me get to the point I am at today.” and “since graduating I have continued to pursue more projects in the coding world. Some analysis projects, business models, and even some fun web apps and game designs. I appreciate all the help and motivation you gave me in class as it helped me to really see what I can come up with from all of the useful tools, how to plan and build on projects, and skills gained from having you as my professor.”

And they work in academia, and students appreciate my approach and style: “I am reaching out to explore the possibility of having you as my graduate advisor. My experience in your Data Management course left a lasting impression on me and I appreciated your approach and teaching style. I believe your guidance would be invaluable in helping me navigate the academic journey towards finishing my doctoral degree.” and “This is Teacher Appreciation Week and I just wanted to take a moment to say thank you for all the hard work and dedication you put into teaching. Your passion for education has inspired and impacted me in so many ways. Your commitment to helping your students grow and learn is truly admirable. Thank you for all that you do!” and “Please know that I deeply appreciate everything you have done for me, and I recognize the many ways you have helped me grow as a scholar and, frankly, as an agentic person in general. I am truly grateful for you.”

And my classes might have even contributed to retention in the program: ““I have learnt so much about my region is really unbelievable and I have enjoyed working with you a lot. So much, I am actually considering STAYING in the program because of you!”

““It was not an easy period for me, but your belief in me made a significant difference in helping me see it through. I recall one of your emails when you wrote, “...you have a passion for this, pursue it.” That statement has stayed with me. It reflected a genuine interest in my success, and I hope I am able to pay it forward.”

from:
to: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
date: Apr 15, 2026, 10:19
subject: Re: Request to pay open access APC from prof okulicz-kozaryn [260318-025834]

[...]Reflecting on this journey now, I just want to say that it was a great pleasure to work with you and to meet you Dr.Adam. But in this digital world, we will continue to communicate for sure and maybe do more work together in the future.

from:
to: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
date: Apr 23, 2026, 10:07
subject: Re: grant opportunity
mailed-by:

Dear Dr. Adam,

I hope you are doing well.

I wanted to take a moment to sincerely appreciate you for your support throughout my master's program. It was not an easy period for me, but your belief in me

I also wanted to share that I was selected as a finalist for the PhD in Global Urban Studies at Rutgers Newark, and I completed the interview process. However,

So you will definitely be seeing me again. :)

Thank you again for everything you've done to support me. I truly value your guidance

Warm regards

From:
Sent: Wednesday, April 8, 2026 12:19 AM
To: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <ao264@camden.rutgers.edu>
Subject: Fw: SEVIS Data Pull 4/6/2026 - Fall 2026

Dr. Adam,

I would be remiss if I didn't share that my day job includes working in Python all the time. The Director of the Office of International Students sends an Excel file each week that is essentially a data dump, and I've used all three of the classes I took with you to make sense of it each time. Without what I learned in your classes, it would just be a random Excel file - and I like Excel. This is just a small piece of it - I was emailing late into the night with her about ban lists and communication strategy, and that entire conversation would not have been possible without the visualizations.

I also create the attached HTML, which I share each week with my colleagues, and we've been relying on it for real decision-making. The HTML is about 85% for me - I regularly echo your point about adding notes to the data. That's what people talk about more than the visuals. They look at the charts, but they look forward to my notes.

I really appreciate everything I learned in your classes and your guidance in both my professional and academic work.

From:

Sent: Wednesday, January 21, 2026 11:21 AM

The classes I took with you are helping not only my scholarship, but my day job. Thank you.

Again, thank you for sharing your knowledge and mentorship. I greatly appreciate it.

indep stu dec18 2025

Hi Professor,

I really appreciate it! Thank you so much!

Again, I am truly grateful to have been a student of yours and learn so much from you.

Have an amazing holiday!

J

2024-04-26 Fri gmail "Dissertation development credit issue and thank you"

Also - thank you. I realize that I have spent so much time this semester focusing on what I needed to do that I neglected to ever tell you how grateful I have been for our work together. I know that I can be a real pain in the ass, and you have definitely experienced that more than anyone else at Rutgers - six credits of courses with me and chairing my dissertation committee! Please know that I deeply appreciate everything you have done for me, and I recognize the many ways you have helped me grow as a scholar and, frankly, as an agentic person in general. I am truly grateful for you.

<2024-04-21 Sun> gmail: class "Completed sections"

"I have learnt so much about my region is really unbelievable and I have enjoyed working with you a lot. So much, I am actually considering STAYING in the program because of you!"

sp22 swb May 12 at 15:30pm

Hi, Dr. Adam. Here are the materials of my final work. I follow the instructions of JPAM style. The word document may not be as neat as the PDF one due to some technical issues. I am excited that it is my first quantitative paper, although there is still a long way from publication. Thank you so much for you help! Your classes have improved me a lot. I had never thought about being able to use these knowledges before taking your classes. Thank you!

Besides, could we keep working on this paper during this summer? It will be my great honor to make a publishment with you.

from:

to:Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>

date:Jun 25, 2018, 8:26 PM

subject:Received a Job Offer

Dr. Okulicz-Kozaryn,

I would like to thank you for all of the guidance and knowledge during all of your data-related courses the past several semesters to help me get to the point I am at today.

I was extended an offer with the Philadelphia School District as a Strategy Analyst with their Charter School Office. The office itself oversees Philadelphia's 84 charter schools (and 70k+ students). I will be doing a lot with the student level data in regard to performance/monitoring and helping with policy/research.

Thanks Again.

from:

to: "adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com" <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>

date: Oct 17, 2023
subject: Graduate Advisor Inquiry
mailed-by: em.rutgers.edu

Good Afternoon Professor Adam,

I hope this email finds you well! My name is xxx and I had the privilege of taking your Data Management course during the spring 2022 semester. I am currently enrolled in Rutgers-Camden's new PhD program in Prevention Science. I am reaching out to explore the possibility of having you as my graduate advisor. My experience in your Data Management course left a lasting impression on me and I appreciated your approach and teaching style. I believe your guidance would be invaluable in helping me navigate the academic journey towards finishing my doctoral degree. I am a part-time student with an expected completion date during the fall 2026 semester. My preliminary dissertation topic is research around the causal effects of a need-based aid program at Rutgers-New Brunswick using a quasi-experimental design such as regression discontinuity.

Please let me know if you prefer to discuss this over a Zoom call.

Best,

from:
to: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
date: May 8, 2025
subject: Re: independent study

Hello Professor Okulicz-Kozaryn,

I have updated my github not only with my up to date notebook like I mentioned yesterday but I also uploaded this txt file as a writeup like you requested: <https://github.com/>

If there is anything else you need from me, please let me know regarding the Independent Study.

I also want to say I am very happy to have taken your classes and had you to work with for this Independent study. I want to say the knowledge that you have helped me obtain along with the projects created are very much so appreciated.

I plan not only to continue research for this topic relating to music and spotify, but I am also going to take these concepts and principles for designing and working on projects with some other future endeavors as well.

And if you ever want to contact me for the future for any projects or know of any good opportunities for work or any other connections within the data science community you can contact me at:

I hope you have a good rest of your year and you enjoy your summer!

from:
to: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
date: Jan 25, 2026
subject: Re: independent study

Hello Professor Okulicz-Kozaryn,

This was an interesting read, I agree, it seems to be a similar idea to that one project I did for your class. Thanks for sending this along to me!

I may take some inspiration from this and add on to that previous project for continuing music analysis trends in the real world.

Also, I want to share that since graduating I have continued to pursue more projects in the coding world. Some analysis projects, business models, and even some fun web apps and game designs. I appreciate all the help and motivation you gave me in class as it helped me to really see what I can come up with from all of the useful tools, how to plan and build on projects, and skills gained from having you as my professor.

Thanks and hope all is well with you!

from:
to: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
cc:
date: Dec 25, 2025
subject: Christmas Greetings
mailed-by: icloud.com

Hi Prof. Adam,

Wishing you a very Merry Christmas and a joyful holiday season. I hope you're enjoying a restful break and some well-deserved time.

I've been thinking back on my time in the PhD program and remain very grateful for your guidance and support along the way. I hope the new year brings you good health, energy, and many exciting moments ahead.

Warm holiday wishes,

from:
to: adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com
date: Nov 28, 2024
subject: Inquiry about Data Management Course
mailed-by: scarletmail.rutgers.edu

Hello Professor,

I hope this email finds you well. Happy Thanksgiving!

I am writing this email after seeing the Data Management course you will be teaching in Spring 2025. If possible, I would like to know more about the course curriculum. The subject is an area of interest for me, and I am enthusiastic about enrolling in the course. I have thoroughly enjoyed being in your GIS class and I look forward to learning more under your guidance.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Regards,

from:
to: Kelly Esterly <kelly.esterly@rutgers.edu>,
Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
date: Aug 5, 2025
subject: Capstone Project
mailed-by: scarletmail.rutgers.edu

Hello Prof. Adam,

I hope this email finds you well. I am reaching out to you for your guidance on my Capstone project in Fall '25. It was a great learning experience to take your classes. I look forward to working under your mentorship.

I am also having @Kelly Esterly on loop so she could issue the special code for the course

Looking forward to hearing from you. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Warm Regards,

from:
to: adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com
date: Oct 19, 2023
subject: Research opportunity Enquiry
mailed-by: scarletmail.rutgers.edu

Hello Professor ,

I'm xxx and I'm currently in your GIS class .It is great learning from you and I have been really enjoying studying subject.

I was wondering if there is any research /project opportunity to work with you ?
Is it possible to come visit you to talk regarding this at your convenience?

Thank you in advance
Regards ,

to: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
date: May 2, 2023
subject: Thank you
mailed-by: gmail.com

Hi Dr. Adam,
This is Teacher Appreciation Week and I just wanted to take a moment to say thank you for all the hard work and dedication you put into teaching. Your passion for education has inspired and impacted me in so many ways. Your commitment to helping your students grow and learn is truly admirable. Thank you for all that you do!

Respectfully,

5.5 Service

Reviewing for journals: journals and counts are in the CV on p. 4: https://theaok.github.io/okulicz_kozaryn_cv.pdf#page=4